



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

pīḍanāni ca sarvāṇi vyasanāni tathā-eva ca | 9.299a
ārabheta tataḥ kāryaṃ sañcintya guru.lāghavam || 299 || 9.299c
ārabheta-eva karmāṇi śrāntaḥ śrāntaḥ punaḥ punaḥ | 9.300a
karmāṇy ārabhamāṇaṃ hi puruṣaṃ śrīr niṣevate || 300 || 9.300c
kṛtaṃ tretāyugaṃ ca-eva dvāparaṃ kalir eva ca | 9.301a
rājño vṛttāni sarvāṇi rājā hi yugam ucyate || 301 || 9.301c

— Manusmṛiti, 9.1.6.2. Excursus: Activities of the King (Chapter 2), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Manusmriti, nestled within the section on the King's duties, speaks to the nature of action, perseverance, and the profound influence of leadership on the world. It begins by acknowledging the inevitable presence of suffering and misfortune, reminding you that life is not without its challenges. The key is to thoughtfully consider the weight and importance of each task before embarking upon it. This initial reflection prevents rash decisions and ensures your energies are directed wisely.

The scripture then emphasizes the importance of persistent effort. Even when weary, you are encouraged to return to your duties, again and again. This isn't a call to mindless toil, but rather a testament to the power of dedication. It's a recognition that sustained effort, even when punctuated by moments of rest, is the path to achievement. The passage assures us that prosperity, or "Shri," favors those who actively engage in their responsibilities. This prosperity isn't just material wealth; it encompasses holistic well-being and fulfillment that arises from a life of purpose.

The final verse elevates the role of the leader, stating that the King embodies the very essence of the ages – Krita, Treta, Dvapara, and Kali. This signifies that the leader's conduct shapes the moral and spiritual climate of the entire era. A virtuous leader fosters an environment of righteousness and progress, while a corrupt leader ushers in decline. This applies not just to monarchs, but to anyone in a position of influence – parents, teachers, managers, and even ourselves in our own lives. Your actions, your choices, ripple outwards, influencing the world around you.

In modern life, this wisdom translates to the importance of mindful action, perseverance in the face of adversity, and the recognition that your behavior has a profound impact on your community and the world at large. It's a call to embrace responsibility, to act with integrity, and to strive for excellence in all that you do, knowing that your efforts contribute to the collective well-being.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you approaching your responsibilities with thoughtful consideration and sustained effort, recognizing the ripple effect of your actions on the world around you?